Persimmon API 101

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Link to our API doc: https://persimmon.humansand.ai/docs

Note: Persimmon is an early research release, and we expect there to be rough edges. We welcome any feedback you have on what is working well or not. Please feel free to email us at `persimmon@humansand.ai`.

Data Types

Conversational

Persimmon is a model trained on **chat and forum data**. It was *not* trained on other kinds of structured data, including data with **tool use** or **survey responses**. It was also not trained on data from advanced technical domains; we therefore do **not recommend** using Persimmon for **knowledge work**.

Languages

Persimmon was trained on **English** data. While its base model, NVIDIA-Nemotron-3-Ultra-550B-A55B, was trained on other languages, we do not recommend using Persimmon in languages other than English.

Text only

Persimmon was trained only on **text** data. It does *not* take in or generate other types of modalities, including audio and text.

URLs

While Persimmon was trained on URLs and may therefore sometimes generate links, these URLs may not point to real links. We generally discourage using generated URLs.

Settings

Persimmon optionally takes in descriptions of *settings*. A setting is a natural language, present-tense description that grounds the conversation that Persimmon should generate. It contains information like:

- **Contextual information** about where and when the conversation is taking place
- **How the conversation plays out**
- **Information about register** or any **quirks** of the domain

We provide examples of the kinds of settings that Persimmon was trained to take in below:

Examples

Example 1

> Startup founders debating co-founder necessity, arguing from personal experience and statistics, exchanging long essay-like posts and brief pointed challenges

Example 2

- Casual chat in a winter/Christmas-themed channel with six participants.
- Participants trade rapid, short messages with frequent typos, all-caps text, and custom emoji codes.
- Multiple people post song lyrics in all-caps across consecutive messages, sometimes overlapping or singing together.
- Users reply to specific messages, use bot commands like ?afk and ?warn, and exchange brief teasing remarks.

Example 3

> Four participants discuss a speculative question about dreams and death. They communicate in brief, casual replies, with one user dismissing the premise, another defending it, and a third agreeing with the defense.

Profiles

Persimmon can optionally take a profile for each participant in a conversation. A profile is a **natural-language description** of the person, including their personality, beliefs, experiences, and behavior.

Profiles can be written in the first, second, or third person, and can use Markdown, bullet points, or paragraphs. Each participant profile (`description`) is limited to **32,000 characters**; the combined setup must also fit the model's context limit. Profiles may include:

- Demographic information
- Occupation
- Relationships with other people
- Past and future beliefs
- Speaking and typing style

When describing past or future beliefs, make sure to **distinguish them through tense**, using the past or present tense to describe general traits and future tense to describe behavior the user is expected to exhibit at some point in the conversation.

We do not recommend including rules or explicit instructions in participant profiles, such as “only speak in lowercase” or “generate 2-3 sentences.” Persimmon is not an instruction-following model. Its purpose is to model the variation of real human behavior, so it may not consistently express a particular trait, reveal specific information, or follow a prescribed rule.

Here are some examples of profiles that Persimmon can take:

Examples

Example 1

1. I am a startup founder
2. I worked in transaction services and was a Deloitte auditor
3. I argued that public offerings are too costly and often unneeded
4. I advocated for private companies issuing dividends

Example 2

> You develop applications using managed and native code, with a graphics compatibility layer. You clarified your goal of calling a native library through a managed wrapper rather than directly from the application. You also confirmed that the required import library was already included in the linker dependencies.

Example 3

> Nelson is a soon-to-graduate computer science student whose strong academic record masks a deep uncertainty about transitioning from classroom theory to professional practice, leaving him feeling like a jack-of-all-trades who has yet to find his true passion. Earnest and intellectually curious, he implements algorithms for fun but readily admits his practical gaps in areas like version control and databases, embracing the community's advice with genuine gratitude rather than defensiveness. He is increasingly drawn to the idea of prioritizing fulfilling work and mentorship over a high-paying but uninspiring corporate role, a stance shaped by his current online degree program that has left him navigating his career launch without a peer network or seasoned guide to show him the ropes.

Harness

The API supports running Persimmon both with and without the harness. In general, we recommend calling Persimmon with the harness, as there are some known issues when Persimmon is run without it. The numbers reported in our blog were all measured with the harness off. Turning the harness on generally improves these numbers and does not cause regressions.

Timestamps are **off by default** (`timestamps=False`). Set `timestamps=True` when creating a conversation to enable them; the mode is fixed for that conversation. When enabled, include a timestamp on every seeded turn. **Returned timestamps are in UTC**. Input timestamps with timezone offsets are normalized to UTC; **if no timezone is supplied, the timestamp is treated as UTC**. Persimmon can generate a wide range of timestamps including when rerunning the same conversation, so we generally do not recommend using Persimmon as a timestamp predictor.

Seeding with Human Data

In general, we have found that Persimmon performs better when conversations are **seeded with human data**, even with as few as **2-5 turns**. We recommend seeding conversations with real human data when using Persimmon. We generally discourage using synthetic data to seed conversations.

Simulating AI Participants

Although Persimmon can simulate participants that are themselves **AI** systems, **we do not generally recommend this** as the primary use case. If you would like Persimmon to generate turns for an AI participant, please explicitly mark that participant as an AI in their profile or settings. Even if you do not plan to use Persimmon to generate turns for the AI, we still recommend providing a profile for any AI participant and **marking them as AI.**

When using external AI models, you may also want to consider how to select who speaks next. Persimmon will select amongst the given list of users provided when choosing turns; if someone who isn't in that list speaks next, this will be out-of-distribution for the model. Persimmon can select an external AI model as the next speaker, but you may want to override this behavior or implement a different strategy that allows an external AI model to interject in the conversation or override Persimmon's selected next speaker.

Prohibited Use Cases

We provide access to Persimmon in good faith and expect that it will not be used for experiments involving AI companions, specific non-anonymized people, or sexual role-play. Persimmon should also not be used to exfiltrate or disclose private information.

Users are expected to respect the privacy of any real people they simulate and to use appropriate discretion when designing and conducting experiments.